

Some of us at *Digit* have used K9 for a while, and have found that it reaches good performance levels about a month from installation (given that you receive about 10 mails a day, and that seven of those are spam). Unfortunately, with anti-spam software, “good” is never good enough—you’ll still need to periodically check for ‘false positives’: good mails that have been classified as spam! You don’t want to lose even one good mail a month, do you?

7.5 Folder And Drive Protection Software

We’d bet our last penny you’ve got something on your computer you don’t want anyone else to see! Besides, you might also want to limit access to your computer in some ways—for example, you might not want your friend to mess with your Control Panel.

There are many, many programs out there that allow you to hide, encrypt, password-protect, or otherwise limit access to files or regions of your computer. But what about freeware? Unfortunately, it turns out there aren’t too many. You could search, but here are a couple of essential software.

7.5.1 The Microsoft TweakUI Powertoy

TweakUI helps in tweaking several—albeit small—aspects of your system. We’ve included it in this section because you can use it to hide drives, and if hiding drives is all you need to do, TweakUI is perfect. Of course, it offers no security—anyone who clicks on ‘Program Files’ and then goes to ‘TweakUI’ can restore visibility of all drives. But still, if someone is going to use your computer for a brief while and for some reason you’d rather some drives didn’t show up, this is the tool for you.

Hiding drives with TweakUI is easy as a-b-c. Just click ‘Drives’, and uncheck the drives you want to make invisible. When next you fire up Windows Explorer, the drives will not show up, and there won’t be anything on the status bar either, saying “Plus two hidden” or something of that sort.